

ALCHEMIZE RESOURCE LIBRARY · INDIVIDUAL TAX

Individual Tax Preparation Organizer

Start from what happened this year, not tax jargon -- and let that lead you to the right documents.

USE THIS WORKBOOK TO

- ◆ Turn this year's life events into a list of documents to look for
- ◆ Track what is received, missing, or corrected
- ◆ Organize questions for your preparer before the appointment
- ◆ Leave with a clear, honest filing-readiness picture

ESTIMATED TIME
25-35 minutes

HAVE NEARBY
Last year's return, any notices you received, a folder for this year's documents

The easiest way to find your missing documents is not to think about tax forms. It is to think about your year: did you change jobs, move, get married, buy a home, start freelancing, or receive a notice? Each answer points to a document category below.

START HERE

Check anything that applies, even loosely. You can sort out exactly which document you need once you know which categories apply to you.

01 LIFE EVENTS CHECKLIST

- | | |
|--------------------------|---|
| ☐ | Changed jobs, retired, or had a major income change |
| ☐ | Moved to a new home or a new state |
| ☐ | Got married, divorced, or had a dependent join or leave the household |
| ☐ | Bought or sold a home, or had investment activity |
| ☐ | Began self-employment, freelance, or platform / gig work |
| ☐ | Received a tax notice, or made estimated payments |

Tax year	Taxpayer	Spouse, if applicable	Preferred contact

Life event details and dates

A change is not an answer

A life event does not automatically create a particular tax result. Record it so your preparer can determine what questions and documentation actually apply.

What that points to

Each life event above usually points to a specific document category. Use this as your search list, then confirm what you actually have.

01 LIFE EVENT TO DOCUMENT MAP

If this happened...	Look for...
Job change or major income change	W-2s, final pay stub, severance records
Move	Updated address on all accounts, moving expense records if applicable
Marriage, divorce, or dependent change	Marriage/divorce records, dependent's SSN, custody documentation
Home purchase, sale, or investment activity	Closing statements, brokerage statements, 1099s
Self-employment or gig work	Platform payout summaries, expense records, 1099-NEC/K
Notice or estimated payments	The notice itself, payment confirmations

02 EXPECTED INCOME DOCUMENTS

Document / source	Expected?	Received	Still missing
Employment (W-2, wages, benefits)			
Retirement / government benefits			
Interest / dividends / brokerage			
Self-employment / platform income			
Rental / property			

Use your actual sources

The map above is a starting prompt, not a universal list. Build your expected-document list from what actually happened to you this year.

Deductions, credits, and records

Organize the records that explain why a line item exists -- the fact, the income source, the payment, or the event behind the question.

01 SUPPORTING RECORDS BY CATEGORY

Category	Records located	Question / follow-up
Education / childcare		
Charitable giving		
Mortgage / property		
Health-related tax forms		
Retirement contributions		
Business or self-employment expenses		

02 PRIOR-YEAR AND RECORD QUALITY CHECK

- ☐ Complete prior-year return is available
- ☐ Carryforward or recurring items noted
- ☐ Unresolved notices identified
- ☐ Each document is readable, complete, and clearly labeled by year

Missing document tracker

When something is missing, do not guess from memory. Confirm it was expected, request it, and track the follow-up.

WHEN A DOCUMENT IS MISSING

Confirm it was expected, check the issuer's portal, request the replacement, and record the date -- then tell your preparer if it is still pending.

01 MISSING-ITEM TRACKER

Missing item	Issuer	Date requested	Status

02 IRS / STATE CORRESPONDENCE

Agency / notice type	Notice date	Deadline	Needs review?

Corrected documents

A corrected document can change your final return. Keep a simple record of what was received, what was corrected, and what changed -- do not assume it matches the original.

Final readiness

Before you share anything, confirm your records are complete, organized, and understandable. The goal is not to send everything -- it is to send what explains the facts and the open questions.

- ☐ Expected income records reviewed against life events
- ☐ Missing records tracked and followed up
- ☐ Estimated payments and prior-year return identified
- ☐ Notices included and questions written down
- ☐ Secure sharing method confirmed
- ☐ Direct-deposit information provided only through an approved method

01 QUESTIONS FOR YOUR PREPARER

Questions and facts to review

02 AFTER FILING

- ☐ Retain the final return and supporting documentation
- ☐ Record carryforward, recurring, and next-year improvement notes

Security reminder

Do not send Social Security numbers, banking information, tax returns, or identification documents through an unsecured contact form or ordinary email. Use only an approved secure method when instructed.

NEXT STEP

THE PAPERWORK IS ORGANIZED. LET'S FILE IT RIGHT.

Need help organizing tax preparation? Schedule a consultation at getalchemize.com.

getalchemize.com

This organizer provides general preparation guidance. It does not determine tax treatment, guarantee a refund or other outcome, or replace advice based on current law and your facts.